

INDIA'S SPECIALIZED INVESTMENT FUND UNIVERSE · VOL 1, NO. 1 · MAY 2026

The category nobody saw coming just crossed **₹10,000 crore**.

In 14 months, SEBI's Specialized Investment Fund has done what AIF Cat-III took a decade to do. This is the flagship public coverage report: **24 live SIFs** ranked and read, **4 NFOs** calendared, **₹10,620 crore** of AUM dissected, and the full HNI allocation playbook — published by the Trustner Asset Services Research Desk.

₹10,620_{Cr}

CATEGORY AUM

24

SIFS TRACKED

13

AMCS LIVE

7

SEBI CATEGORIES

12.5%

EQUITY LTCG

A category, quietly assembled.

In December 2024 a SEBI bureaucrat wrote a circular almost nobody read. Eighteen months later, ₹10,620 crore has quietly migrated into the category it created — a category that did not exist when the most recent budget was tabled. The Specialized Investment Fund, or SIF, is the most consequential change to Indian wealth-management plumbing since the demat account.

It is also one of the least understood. Search "what is SIF" and you will find blogs that describe it as "a new mutual fund category." That is technically correct in the way that calling a Cessna "a new type of bicycle" is technically correct: the regulatory wrapper is shared, and the toolkit is utterly different. SIFs short stocks. They run dynamic equity-debt bands of negative-seven to positive-seventy-five percent net equity. They sit, by deliberate design, at the precise gap between mutual fund and Portfolio Management Service — a gap that, before April 2025, contained roughly nine million Indian households with liquid AUM between ten lakhs and two crores. Those households were either over-served by retail products or unable to access the ones built for the very rich.

The SIF closes that gap with what is, in this Editor's view, the single most efficient piece of financial-product engineering the Indian regulator has shipped in twenty years. The minimum is set at ten lakh aggregate per PAN per AMC — high enough to keep retail out, low enough to admit the new affluent. The taxation is mutual-fund-grade — twelve-point-five percent long-term capital gains on the equity-oriented bucket, which compounds into a structural advantage of roughly seventy lakh of preserved wealth per crore over a decade against an equivalent AIF Cat-III. The fund managers are top-shelf: Sankaran Naren is running ICICI Prudential's iSIF; Bharat Lahoti and Dhawal Dalal anchor Edelweiss Altiva; Gaurav Mehta runs SBI Magnum's first SIF allocation.

The number that should make every advisor pay attention is not the AUM total. It is the rate of change. ₹4,892 crore in December 2025. ₹9,711 crore in February 2026. ₹10,620 crore in March. Twenty-four live products as we go to press, four in active NFO, eight AMCs in the SEBI clearance queue. This is the early-Vanguard moment for the Indian alternatives market. The desks that build research credibility now will own the conversation for the decade.

This first issue of *The MeraSIF Coverage Report* sets the foundation. We have walked the regulatory architecture, sized the universe, modelled the tax math at the household level, calendared every NFO open through Q2, and laid out the allocation playbook by corpus tier. We have done so in the public — no paywall, no embargo, no "premium tier." Our view is that the more investors understand this category, the better the conversations Trustner advisors get to have. We are betting on education compounding faster than gatekeeping.

One more thing. SIFs have not been tested through a full market cycle. The category is fourteen months old. The hybrid strategies validated their thesis through the Nifty -11.3% March drawdown; the pure equity long-short strategies, generally, did not. Every figure in this report carries the implicit caveat that distinguishes good research from marketing: we do not know what we do not know yet. Read accordingly.

★ THE 30-SECOND TAKEAWAY

SIF is the right wrapper for the Indian investor with ₹10 lakh to ₹2 crore of liquid AUM. The category is fourteen months old, ₹10,620 Cr in size, and dominated by hybrid long-short strategies that delivered through March 2026's market drawdown. Three foundational SIFs (Altiva, Magnum, iSIF Hybrid) form a defensible core; the equity sleeve is best held lightly until track records mature. Build a position now; the institutional second wave is launching this quarter.

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01 Executive Snapshot

The numbers that matter, in one page.

Three facts define this category in May 2026.

First, scale. The Specialized Investment Fund category crossed ₹10,000 crore in AUM by March 2026 — fourteen months from the first NFO, eighteen months from SEBI's enabling amendment. Twenty-four products are live or in NFO. Thirteen AMCs have launched or filed. Hybrid Long-Short strategies hold roughly 77% of category AUM (≈₹8,147 Cr); equity-oriented strategies the remaining 23% (≈₹2,474 Cr).

Second, structural advantage. SIFs inherit Section 10(23D) fund-level tax exemption from their parent mutual fund trust structure. Long-term capital gains on equity-oriented SIFs are taxed at 12.5%. The same gross return inside an AIF Cat-III wrapper — taxed at the fund level at slab rate plus surcharge — yields roughly 3.2 percentage points less of post-tax IRR per annum for a top-bracket investor. Over a decade on a ₹1 crore allocation, that arithmetic compounds to seventy to eighty lakhs of preserved wealth.

Third, the moment. The second wave of AMCs is launching *this quarter*. Mirae Asset's Platinum, ICICI Prudential's Active Asset Allocator and Equity Long-Short, Edelweiss's Equity Ex-Top 100, plus pipeline filings from HDFC, Nippon India, UTI, Axis and DSP. By December, the live universe will plausibly double again.

SIF AUM trajectory

Category AUM, ₹ crore — six-month look back. Source: AMFI category disclosures.

Dec 2025		₹4,892 Cr
Jan 2026		₹6,501 Cr
Feb 2026		₹9,711 Cr
Mar 2026		₹10,620 Cr

By strategy mix

Hybrid LS		77%
Equity LS / Ex-Top 100 / Sector		23%
Debt LS / Sectoral Debt		0%

AMCs ranked by SIF AUM (top 5)

SBI MF		₹1,100 Cr
ICICI Prudential		₹1,090 Cr
Edelweiss		₹1,000 Cr
Quant		₹561 Cr
ITI		₹345 Cr

“

The most useful framing for a wealth-management conversation in May 2026 is not "should I buy a SIF?" It is "why am I still paying slab-rate tax on my PMS gains?"

— FROM THE EDITORIAL, PAGE 27

02 A Category Timeline

Eighteen months from regulatory amendment to ₹10,000 crore.

16 DECEMBER 2024

SEBI inserts Chapter VI-C into the Mutual Funds Regulations 1996

A six-line amendment. Nobody publishes a thinkpiece. This is the legal foundation that ensures the SIF inherits Section 10(23D) fund-level tax exemption from its parent mutual fund trust. Without this single sentence, the entire post-tax case for SIF collapses.

27 FEBRUARY 2025

SEBI issues the Master Circular

SEBI/HO/IMD/IMD-PoD-1/P/CIR/2025/26. The architecture lands in a single document: two AMC-eligibility routes, seven permitted strategy categories, the 25% unhedged-short cap, the ₹10 lakh investor floor, the cumulative-exposure ceiling, the bi-monthly disclosure mandate. The market reads it once.

1 APRIL 2025

The framework goes live

Eligible AMCs may file. Nothing happens publicly for five months. Internally, every major AMC is on a sprint.

17 SEPTEMBER 2025

Quant qSIF Equity LS — the first NFO

Sandeep Tandon's VLRT framework applied to long-short. Allotted 7 October. The category has its first scheme. Quant is, simultaneously, dealing with the front-running investigation overhang from 2024-25 — a complication that follows the AMC into the SIF era.

OCTOBER 2025

Edelweiss Altiya and SBI Magnum — the foundational launches

Two hybrid Long-Short SIFs allot within two weeks of each other. Altiya crosses ₹1,000 crore in two months. SBI Magnum raises ₹1,100 Cr at NFO — the largest in category history. The "FD-plus with equity tax" narrative finds its market.

JANUARY 2026

Sankaran Naren enters the category

ICICI Prudential launches iSIF Hybrid and iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 simultaneously, both with Sankaran Naren as lead manager. Equity Ex-Top 100 raises ₹1,090 Cr — the largest equity SIF. Category AUM passes ₹6,500 crore.

FEBRUARY 2026

Peak monthly inflow — ₹3,127 Cr

The fastest monthly category gathering since 2022's small-cap MF mania. Then the Nifty falls 11.3% in March. The hybrid funds hold up; the pure-equity LS funds, generally, do not. Inflows moderate to ₹1,314 Cr in March — a healthy 57% pullback that does *not* spook the category.

APRIL 2026

Second wave SEBI clearance

Kotak (Infinity), Mirae Asset (Platinum), HSBC (RedHex) all receive SEBI clearance for hybrid LS schemes. The category goes from "novelty" to "table stakes" for any AMC competing in the wealth-management corridor.

MAY 2026 (THIS ISSUE)

Twenty-four products. Four in NFO. ₹10,620 crore.

Mirae Asset Platinum, Edelweiss Altiva Equity Ex-Top 100, ICICI Prudential iSIF Active Asset Allocator, ICICI Prudential iSIF Equity Long-Short — all in NFO through 1-3 June. HDFC, Nippon India, UTI, Axis, DSP filings expected through Q2.

WHAT THE TIMELINE TELLS US

Eighteen months is the new norm for a SEBI-built category to find product-market fit.

Compare against the AIF Cat-III rollout (2012 regulation, meaningful AUM only by 2018), the REIT framework (2014, meaningful only by 2019), and the InvIT framework (2014, still finding its audience). The SIF's speed-to-scale reflects three things: an unmet customer need, an existing distribution muscle (mutual fund distributors immediately had product to sell), and clear tax economics. The next category SEBI launches should study this rollout closely.

03 The SEBI Architecture

Three circulars, seven categories, one elegant piece of regulatory engineering.

The SIF framework rests on three SEBI circulars. The first — **SEBI/HO/IMD/IMD-PoD-1/P/CIR/2025/26**, dated 27 February 2025 — is the master document. It defines who can launch, what they may launch, and how it must be disclosed. The second, dated 9 April 2025, clarifies the minimum-threshold edge cases (passive market drift below ₹10 lakh does *not* trigger forced redemption; active redemption that would breach the floor does). The third, 11 April 2025, standardises the bi-monthly disclosure format into the ISID — the Investment Scheme Information Document — and makes it the mandatory comparison artifact across the category.

Two routes for AMC eligibility

An AMC may sponsor an SIF through one of two routes. The **Sound Track Record Route** requires three years of mutual fund operations, ≥₹10,000 Cr in three-year average AUM, and a clean SEBI record (no Section 11/11B/24 action in three years). This is the route every Tier-1 AMC qualifies for. The **Alternate Route** waives the AUM threshold for smaller AMCs but requires a Chief Investment Officer with ≥10 years of fund-management experience and ≥₹5,000 Cr of AUM personally managed historically — plus a clean regulatory record. Every fund manager named in the SID must hold the NISM-mandated SIF certification.

Seven categories, one strategy per AMC per category

SEBI's anti-proliferation rule is elegant: an AMC may launch only one SIF per strategy category. This is why ICICI Prudential's iSIF Hybrid LS and iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 are distinct products (different categories), but ICICI Prudential cannot run a second Hybrid LS strategy alongside the iSIF Hybrid. The seven permitted categories are:

#	TYPE	SUB-STRATEGY	MINIMUM ALLOCATION	UNHEDGED SHORT
1	Equity	Equity Long-Short	≥80% equity	≤25%
2	Equity	Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short	≥65% in stocks ranked >100 by market cap	≤25%
3	Equity	Sector Rotation Long-Short	≥80% across up to 4 sectors	≤25%
4	Debt	Debt Long-Short	≥80% debt	≤25%
5	Debt	Sectoral Debt Long-Short	Sector-concentrated debt	≤25%
6	Hybrid	Active Asset Allocator Long-Short	Dynamic across equity / debt / commodity	≤25%
7	Hybrid	Hybrid Long-Short ★	Defined equity-debt bands	≤25%

Why exactly seven?

The seven categories are not arbitrary. They are the seven distinct allocation profiles where a long-short toolkit demonstrably adds value over a long-only mutual fund. SEBI mandated this cap precisely to prevent the AIF Cat-III experience — where regulatory permissiveness produced 800+ strategies, of which fewer than 100 are institutional-quality. By restricting categories, SEBI ensures every SIF is structurally comparable to its peers. The ISID disclosure mandate then makes cross-fund analysis possible. This is, in its quiet way, world-class regulatory design.

The investor's floor — and how it actually works

The minimum is ten lakh aggregate per PAN per AMC across all SIF strategies of that AMC. The aggregation is important: an investor can deploy ₹6 lakh into ICICI Pru's iSIF Hybrid and ₹4 lakh into iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100, and meet the ₹10 lakh threshold at ICICI Prudential. The investor cannot, however, split ₹5 lakh across two different AMCs — that fails the floor at both.

Accredited investors qualify at ₹1 lakh. As of May 2026, accreditation infrastructure (SEBI-recognised Accreditation Agencies) is operationally limited and most subscriptions continue to flow through the standard ₹10 lakh route.

Below-threshold drift is handled humanely. A passive market loss that takes an investor's holding below ₹10 lakh requires no action — they stay invested. An active redemption that *would* breach the floor triggers a forced full redemption (no partials below the floor). A thirty-day rebalancing window applies to inadvertent breaches arising from corporate actions, mergers, or restructurings.

SIF vs Mutual Fund vs PMS vs AIF Cat-III

The eleven dimensions that determine which wrapper is right.

The single most useful framing for a wealth-management conversation in May 2026 is the four-way comparison. Each wrapper exists for a reason; SIF does not replace any of them. It claims a slice of the spectrum where, until April 2025, no clean answer existed.

DIMENSION	MUTUAL FUND	SIF	★ PMS	AIF CAT-III
Minimum ticket	₹100–500	₹10 lakh (₹1L accredited)	₹50 lakh	₹1 crore
Regulatory wrapper	SEBI MF Regs 1996	SEBI MF Regs (Ch. VI-C)	SEBI PMS Regs 2020	SEBI AIF Regs 2012
Pooling	Pooled	Pooled	Separate demat per investor	Pooled
Long-short capability	Hedging only	Yes — ≤25% NAV unhedged	Yes (no statutory cap)	Yes (no cap; leverage shorts)
Liquidity	Daily (most)	Daily / weekly / monthly / interval	T+2 to T+5	Lock-in 1–3 yrs typical
Disclosure	Monthly portfolio	Bi-monthly portfolio + ISID	Monthly + on-demand	Quarterly
Tax — Equity (≥65%)	LTCG 12.5%, STCG 20%	LTCG 12.5%, STCG 20%	Slab rate (business income)	Slab rate (Cat-III, fund-level)
Tax — Hybrid <65% eq	LTCG 12.5% (>2y)	LTCG 12.5% (>2y), STCG slab	Slab rate	Slab rate
Tax — Debt	Slab rate	Slab rate	Slab rate	Slab rate
Fund-level tax	Nil — Sec 10(23D)	Nil — Sec 10(23D)	N/A (pass-through)	Cat-III: at fund level
TER / fee cap	~2.25% asset-slab	~2.25%	1–2.5% mgmt + 10–20% perf	1.5–2.5% + 15–20% perf
Performance fee	No	Optional (rare)	Yes	Yes

When SIF wins

Corpus is ₹50 lakh to ₹2 crore
Investor's marginal tax rate is 30%+
Goal is BAF replacement / income-with-equity-tax
Investor wants regulated disclosure rigour
Time horizon ≥ 3 years

When SIF loses

Corpus is below ₹10 lakh (use MF)
Investor wants concentrated 20-stock bets (PMS)
Strategy needs unlimited shorting / leverage (AIF)
Liquidity need is intraday (use ETFs / liquid MF)
Investor is in the 0–20% tax bracket

05 The Tax Math, Worked

Why post-tax IRR is where the SIF case lives.

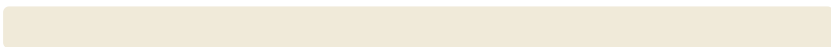
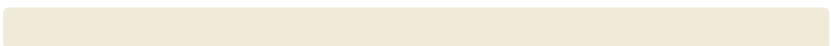
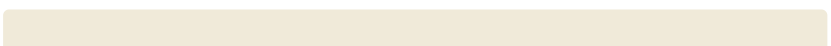
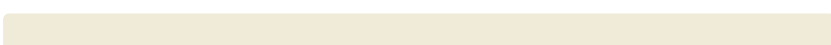
The structural reason SIF gains receive mutual-fund-grade taxation is not policy — it is plumbing. The SIF is, legally, a scheme launched under a mutual fund trust. The trust enjoys Section 10(23D) of the Income Tax Act, which exempts the fund itself from any income tax. Gains compound inside the fund untaxed; tax applies only at investor-level redemption, at the LTCG rate appropriate to the underlying-asset classification.

By contrast, AIF Category III is taxed *at the fund level*, at slab rates plus surcharge. For a top-bracket investor, the effective fund-level tax can reach 42.74% of incremental gains. PMS is structured as pass-through; the gains land as "business income" in the investor's hands, also at slab rates. Neither wrapper carries the Section 10(23D) shield.

The compounding consequences are dramatic. On a ten-year hold of ₹1 crore at 12% gross CAGR, a top-bracket investor:

Final corpus by wrapper — illustrative

Assumes: ₹1 crore initial · 12% gross CAGR · 10-year hold · top-bracket investor (~39% effective). TER assumptions: SIF 0.6%, MF 1.5%, PMS 1.5%+15% perf, AIF Cat-III 2%+15% perf.

SIF (Hybrid LS)		₹2.74 Cr
Equivalent MF		₹2.69 Cr
PMS		₹2.04 Cr
AIF Cat-III		₹1.93 Cr

“

Seventy lakhs is what an HNI loses, per crore of allocation, over ten years, simply by choosing the wrong wrapper. Same strategy. Same gross return. Different tax bucket.

— THE EDITOR

The arithmetic above is illustrative — it assumes constant CAGR, single-asset hold, and no churn. Real portfolios churn; churn worsens the case for slab-rate wrappers and improves the case for fund-level-exempt wrappers. The directional conclusion does not change.

The arithmetic also assumes equity-oriented or arbitrage-heavy hybrid SIFs with 12-month LTCG. Hybrid SIFs with less than 65% equity receive LTCG at 12.5% after a 24-month hold; debt-oriented SIFs receive slab-rate treatment (same as debt mutual funds post-2023). The post-tax delta is largest for top-bracket investors in equity-oriented SIFs versus equivalent AIF Cat-III strategies.

For investors in the 0–20% bracket, the tax-bucket arbitrage compresses significantly. SIF may still be the right structural answer for other reasons — disclosure rigour, lower TER, pooled diversification — but the tax case is materially weaker.

Run the calculator on your own numbers →

06 The Live Universe

All 24 Specialized Investment Funds in India — May 2026.

Twenty-four SIFs are live or in NFO. Thirteen AMCs have launched. The list below is ordered by AMC and presents the canonical universe as of 28 May 2026. Funds in NFO are tagged separately.

Foundational hybrid Long-Short (the category core)

EDELWEISS MF · ALTIVA SIF

01 Altiva Hybrid Long-Short Fund

₹1,000+ Cr

India's first hybrid SIF · Bharat Lahoti, Bhavesh Jain, Dhawal Dalal · NAV ₹10.67 (25 May 2026)

AUM

SBI MF · MAGNUM SIF

02 Magnum Hybrid Long-Short Fund

₹1,100 Cr

Largest NFO raise in category · Gaurav Mehta (solo) · NAV ₹10.35 (25 May 2026)

AUM (NFO)

ICICI PRUDENTIAL · ISIF

03 iSIF Hybrid Long-Short Fund

₹672 Cr

Sankaran Naren · -7.5% to +75% net equity band · BAF replacement positioning

AUM (APR 2026)

TATA MF · TITANIUM SIF

04 Titanium Hybrid Long-Short Fund

Data gap

Multi-asset incl. REITs/InvITs · Suraj Nanda · Monthly redemption only

TATA MF DISCLOSURE

ABSL · APEX SIF

05 Apex Hybrid Long-Short Fund

Data gap

Lovelish Solanki, Dhaval Joshi · ABSL's first SIF

ABSL DISCLOSURE

BANDHAN MF · ARUDHA

06 Arudha Hybrid Long-Short Fund

Data gap

Kirthi Kankonkar, Brijesh Shah · Bandhan's first SIF launch

BANDHAN DISCLOSURE

QUANT MF · QSIF

07

qSIF Hybrid Long-Short Fund

VLRT framework · Sandeep Tandon + team · SEBI overhang from 2024-25 probe

Data gap

QUANT DISCLOSURE

Equity Long-Short and Ex-Top 100

ICICI PRUDENTIAL · ISIF

08

iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short

Sankaran Naren · ≥65% in stocks ranked >100 by m-cap · India's largest equity SIF

₹1,090 Cr

AUM

QUANT MF · QSIF

09

qSIF Equity Long-Short Fund

First-ever SIF NFO in India · VLRT framework applied to flexicap LS

₹561 Cr

AUM

QUANT MF · QSIF

10

qSIF Equity Ex-Top 100

SMID systematic · Sandeep Tandon + team

₹170 Cr

AUM

ITI MF · DIVINITI

11

Diviniti Equity Long-Short Fund

Laukik Bagwe, Vikas Sahgal · Boutique AMC entrant

₹345 Cr

AUM

360 ONE MF · DYNASIF

12

DynaSIF Equity Long-Short

Harsh Agarwal · 14–16% target CAGR (highest in category) · Carve-out from IIFL Wealth alt book

Data gap

360 ONE DISCLOSURE

BANDHAN MF · ARUDHA

13

Arudha Equity Long-Short Fund

Nilesh Saha, Brijesh Shah

Data gap

BANDHAN DISCLOSURE

14	TATA MF · TITANIUM SIF Titanium Equity Long-Short Fund Launched 27 Apr-11 May 2026 · Flexicap LS	NFO closed RECENTLY ALLOTTED
15	FRANKLIN TEMPLETON · SAPPHIRE Sapphire Equity Long-Short SIF Franklin's first SIF · Allotted 4 May 2026	NFO closed RECENTLY ALLOTTED
16	THE WEALTH COMPANY · WSIF WSIF Equity Long-Short New AMC entrant · Allotted late April 2026	NFO closed RECENTLY ALLOTTED
17	THE WEALTH COMPANY · WSIF WSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 SMID variant · Allotted late April 2026	NFO closed RECENTLY ALLOTTED
18	UNION MUTUAL FUND Union Equity Long-Short SIF Recently launched · Union MF's debut in the category	Recently launched 2026
Active Asset Allocator and others		
19	360 ONE MF · DYNASIF DynaSIF Active Asset Allocator First AAA SIF in India · Harsh Agarwal, Mayur Mody, Ravi Khetawat	Data gap 360 ONE DISCLOSURE
20	QUANT MF · QSIF qSIF Active Asset Allocator Multi-asset VLRT framework · Recently allotted (NFO 2-16 Apr 2026)	Recently allotted APR 2026

In active NFO (May–June 2026)

21	NFO ACTIVE Edelweiss Altiva Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short NFO open 18 May – 1 June 2026 · Edelweiss's second SIF · SMID variant	18 May NFO OPENS
22	NFO ACTIVE ICICI Prudential iSIF Active Asset Allocator Long-Short NFO open 19 May – 2 June 2026 · iSIF's third strategy · Active asset rotation	19 May NFO OPENS
23	NFO ACTIVE ICICI Prudential iSIF Equity Long-Short NFO open 19 May – 2 June 2026 · Pure equity LS to complement Ex-Top 100 and Hybrid	19 May NFO OPENS
24	NFO ACTIVE Mirae Asset Platinum Hybrid Long-Short NFO open 20 May – 3 June 2026 · Mirae's first SIF · Hybrid LS category	20 May NFO OPENS

07 May–June 2026 NFO Calendar

Four NFOs, three AMCs, three categories. The category's most active month.

What's open right now

NFO WINDOW	FUND	STRATEGY	AMC
18 May – 1 Jun	Altiva Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short	Equity Ex-Top 100 LS	Edelweiss
19 May – 2 Jun	iSIF Active Asset Allocator Long-Short	Active Asset Allocator	ICICI Prudential
19 May – 2 Jun	iSIF Equity Long-Short	Equity Long-Short	ICICI Prudential
20 May – 3 Jun	Platinum Hybrid Long-Short	Hybrid Long-Short	Mirae Asset

EDITORIAL VIEW ON NFO PARTICIPATION

NFOs are operationally efficient but rarely the right strategic entry.

An NFO subscription locks an investor's capital into an unbuilt portfolio. The AMC has 30 business days (extendable to 60 with Investment Committee approval) to deploy. In a rising market, NFO participants miss the early move; in a falling market, they enter at premium. The exceptions are when (a) the AMC's distribution muscle will gather meaningful NFO AUM and the resulting fund liquidity matters operationally, or (b) the fund manager's prior track record is so strong that day-one entry justifies the deployment risk.

For most investors, waiting for the post-NFO three-month window — when initial portfolio is constructed and early NAV directional read is available — is the better operational call.

08 Performance Reality Check

Hybrid SIFs validated. Equity SIFs did not.

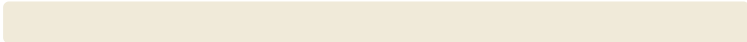
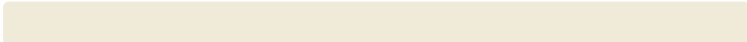
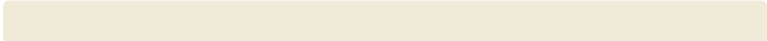
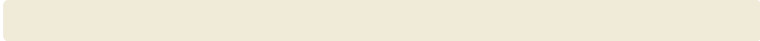
The category had its first stress test in March 2026. The Nifty fell 11.3% in the month. Nifty 500 had already declined 3.76% in January. For a category whose entire pitch includes "long-short capability provides downside protection," this was the moment of truth.

The hybrid Long-Short funds held up. Edelweiss Altiva — designed with 40–60% high-quality fixed income, 20–40% cash-future arbitrage, 0–15% net equity — returned positive through the drawdown. NAV ₹10.67 as of 25 May 2026 (+6.7% since the October 2025 allotment). SBI Magnum, with similar conservative-by-design positioning, sits at ₹10.35 (+3.5%). The thesis — that disciplined hedging plus structural arbitrage produces FD-replacement returns with equity-grade taxation — was, in its first real test, validated.

The pure equity Long-Short funds were a different story. Every equity-oriented SIF traded below the ₹10 issue price through late March. The 25% unhedged-short cap proved structurally insufficient to offset a -11% market move when the long book was running 65–80% net equity exposure. iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 hit a NAV of ₹9.02 in early April (-9.8% since launch). qSIF Equity LS, Diviniti, Arudha Equity LS — all underwater. The "Naren brand" did not exempt iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 from the broader SMID drawdown.

NAV performance since allotment — selected SIFs

NAV as of late May 2026 vs ₹10 NFO issue price. Hybrid SIFs in cyan; equity-oriented in gray.

Altiva Hybrid (Oct '25)		₹10.67 (+6.7%)
Magnum Hybrid (Oct '25)		₹10.35 (+3.5%)
iSIF Hybrid (Jan '26)		₹9.88 (-1.2%)
iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 (Jan '26)		₹9.02 (-9.8%)

Past performance is not indicative of future returns. NAVs sourced from AMC factsheets and Groww / Tickertape aggregations as of late May 2026.

“

The 25% short cap is a structural feature, not a bug. It tells investors that SIFs are designed to express moderated equity views, not to short the market.

— EDITORIAL OBSERVATION

09 The Trustner Fund Score

Our 7-pillar ranking of every SIF. The math is shown — no black box.

Every research desk in the wealth-management business owes its readers two artifacts: an honest opinion, and a transparent framework that produces it. The **Trustner Fund Score (TFS)** is our public framework. It rates each SIF on a 0–100 scale across seven weighted pillars. We are not running a black box — every score below is decomposable into its pillar contributions.

The TFS is reviewed monthly. The scores in this issue reflect the Trustner Research Desk view as of **28 May 2026**. They will change as funds gather track record, AMC platforms scale, and the regulatory environment evolves.

The seven pillars and their weights

#	PILLAR	WEIGHT	WHAT IT MEASURES
P1	Manager Pedigree	20	FM track record on prior funds: alpha vs benchmark, longevity, downside discipline, AUM managed historically
P2	Strategy Coherence	15	Does the strategy logic match the SIF toolkit? Is the alpha thesis defensible? Is the band sensibly set?
P3	AMC Platform Strength	15	Parent AMC AUM, distribution depth, research coverage, governance record, regulatory standing
P4	Cost & Liquidity	10	TER, exit load, redemption frequency, lock-in friction, notice-period rules
P5	Risk Architecture	15	Hedging discipline, position limits, downside cap evidence, drawdown control through the March 2026 stress test
P6	Track Record / Real Performance	15	Alpha vs benchmark since inception — NOT the AUM gathered. (Funds <3 months old are unscorable here)
P7	Investor-fit & Tax Efficiency	10	Tax bucket, suitability matrix, real-world advisor friction

The verdict scale

BUY (80–100) — High conviction, recommended list. Trustner advisors lead with this fund in suitability conversations.

ACCUMULATE (65–79) — Worth allocating; not a lead pitch. Build position over multiple tranches.

HOLD / MONITOR (50–64) — Track quarterly; do not pitch. Re-evaluate at next review.

AVOID (<50) — Not on shelf. Structural concerns outweigh any tactical case.

MONITOR-ID — Insufficient Data — Fund <3 months old or AMC disclosure gap. Pillar P6 unscorable; full TFS deferred.

The TFS ranked master table — all 24 SIFs

Funds are sorted by TFS, highest first. NFOs and funds with insufficient track record carry a MONITOR-ID flag — they will be scored fully once they cross the three-month threshold and AMC disclosure clears.

RANK	FUND	STRATEGY	TFS	VERDICT
1	iSIF Hybrid Long-Short ICICI Prudential · Sankaran Naren	Hybrid LS	78	★ BUY
2	Altiva Hybrid Long-Short Edelweiss · Lahoti / Jain / Dalal	Hybrid LS	76	ACCUMULATE
3	Magnum Hybrid Long-Short SBI · Gaurav Mehta, CFA	Hybrid LS	75	ACCUMULATE
4	iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short ICICI Prudential · Naren / Tijoriwala / Jain	Equity Ex-Top 100 LS	74	★ BUY (satellite)
5	Titanium Hybrid Long-Short Tata MF · Suraj Nanda	Hybrid LS	70	ACCUMULATE
6	DynaSIF Equity Long-Short 360 ONE · Harsh Agarwal	Equity LS	70	ACCUMULATE
7	Apex Hybrid Long-Short ABSL · Solanki / Joshi / Sharma	Hybrid LS	68	ACCUMULATE
8	Arudha Hybrid Long-Short Bandhan · Kankonkar / Shah	Hybrid LS	66	ACCUMULATE
9	DynaSIF Active Asset Allocator 360 ONE · Agarwal / Mody / Khetawat	Active Asset Allocator LS	65	ACCUMULATE
10	qSIF Hybrid Long-Short Quant · Tandon + team	Hybrid LS	64	HOLD
11	qSIF Equity Long-Short Quant · Tandon + 4 FMs	Equity LS	62	HOLD
12	Titanium Equity Long-Short Tata MF · Recently allotted Apr-May 2026	Equity LS	—	MONITOR-ID
13	Arudha Equity Long-Short Bandhan · Saha / Shah	Equity LS	—	MONITOR-ID
14	qSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 Quant · Tandon / Pande / Kate	Equity Ex-Top 100 LS	—	MONITOR-ID + Quant overhang
15	Diviniti Equity Long-Short ITI MF · Bagwe / Sahgal	Equity LS	—	MONITOR-ID

RANK	FUND	STRATEGY	TFS	VERDICT
16	Sapphire Equity Long-Short Franklin Templeton · Recently allotted May 2026	Equity LS	—	MONITOR-ID
17	qSIF Active Asset Allocator Quant · Recently allotted Apr 2026	Active Asset Allocator LS	—	MONITOR-ID + Quant overhang
18	WSIF Equity Long-Short The Wealth Co.	Equity LS	—	MONITOR-ID (new AMC)
19	WSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 The Wealth Co.	Equity Ex-Top 100 LS	—	MONITOR-ID (new AMC)
20	Union Equity Long-Short SIF Union MF	Equity LS	—	MONITOR-ID
NFO	Altiva Equity Ex-Top 100 LS Edelweiss · NFO 18 May–1 Jun	Equity Ex-Top 100 LS	—	In NFO
NFO	iSIF Active Asset Allocator LS ICICI Pru · NFO 19 May–2 Jun	Active Asset Allocator LS	—	In NFO
NFO	iSIF Equity Long-Short ICICI Pru · NFO 19 May–2 Jun	Equity LS	—	In NFO
NFO	Platinum Hybrid Long-Short Mirae Asset · NFO 20 May–3 Jun	Hybrid LS	—	In NFO

The four recommended-list funds — TFS pillar breakdown

Two BUYs and two top-of-shelf ACCUMULATES make the Trustner recommended list. Below, the pillar-by-pillar decomposition of each.

★ iSIF Hybrid Long-Short Fund • ICICI Prudential • TFS 78 — BUY

Role: Balanced Advantage Fund replacement for the ₹50L+ HNI. Naren-led, with -7.5% to +75% net equity flexibility — the widest band in the hybrid SIF universe. Tax: 12.5% LTCG after 12 months.

PILLAR	SCORE	REASONING
P1 Manager Pedigree (20)	19	Sankaran Naren is the single strongest pedigree signal in the SIF universe — 35+ yrs, ICICI Pru CIO, ₹1L Cr+ BAF builder
P2 Strategy Coherence (15)	13	Wide -7.5% to +75% net equity band gives real tactical flexibility; arbitrage + covered calls + IRF + unhedged short up to 10%
P3 AMC Platform (15)	14	ICICI Pru AMC ~₹9L Cr AUM; 550+ companies, 27 sectors covered; deep research bench
P4 Cost & Liquidity (10)	6	TER 0.99% direct (highest in hybrid SIF universe — penalty); 1% exit <12mo; daily redemption ✓
P5 Risk Architecture (15)	11	March '26 stress: fell -6.4% vs benchmark -6.7% (modest outperformance, not the full structural hedge claimed)
P6 Track Record (15)	8	-1.2% in 6 months — underperformed both Altiva and Magnum since launch
P7 Tax & Investor Fit (10)	7	Wide equity range may qualify for 12-mo LTCG; suitable for emerging affluent through HNI

Altiva Hybrid Long-Short Fund • Edelweiss • TFS 76 — ACCUMULATE

Role: FD-replacement for retirees and conservative HNIs. Income-oriented hybrid: 40–60% high-quality fixed income, 20–40% cash-future arbitrage, 0–15% net equity. India's first hybrid SIF. NAV ₹10.67 (25 May 2026) — the best 6-month track record in the category.

PILLAR	SCORE	REASONING
P1 Manager Pedigree (20)	17	Top-quartile bench across equity (Lahoti, Jain), debt (Dalal — ex-DSP), and arbitrage. Five FMs de-risk key-person concentration
P2 Strategy Coherence (15)	12	Conservative-by-design; matches the "FD+ with equity tax" thesis precisely
P3 AMC Platform (15)	12	Edelweiss MF AUM ~₹2.0L Cr; Radhika Gupta brand drives distribution
P4 Cost & Liquidity (10)	8	Direct TER ~0.40% (best in category); twice-weekly (Mon/Wed) redemption — minor friction
P5 Risk Architecture (15)	12	Cash-future arb + covered calls — tested low-vol toolkit. Held up through March '26 drawdown
P6 Track Record (15)	8	+6.7% in 7 months through a -11% Nifty crash is genuine validation
P7 Tax & Investor Fit (10)	7	Hybrid <65% equity → 24-mo LTCG window; ideal FD-replacement

Magnum Hybrid Long-Short Fund • SBI MF • TFS 75 — ACCUMULATE

Role: Trust play for SBI ecosystem clients and risk-averse HNIs. 65–75% equity (heavily hedged), 25–35% debt, 0–25% unhedged short. Net equity typically 10–15%. NFO raised ~₹1,100 Cr — largest single SIF launch.

PILLAR	SCORE	REASONING
P1 Manager Pedigree (20)	15	Gaurav Mehta — 19 yrs, quant + alternative strategies background. -5 for solo FM key-person risk
P2 Strategy Coherence (15)	11	Net equity 10–15% via heavy hedging — coherent FD+ design, conservative by intent
P3 AMC Platform (15)	15	SBI is India's largest AMC (~₹11.5L Cr AUM); unmatched distribution; investor trust premium
P4 Cost & Liquidity (10)	8	TER ~0.42% direct; redemption Mon/Thu (twice-weekly)
P5 Risk Architecture (15)	11	0–75% hedged exposure flexibility; covered calls + arbitrage. Validated through March '26 drawdown
P6 Track Record (15)	9	+3.5% in 7 months — held up through the crash but didn't shine
P7 Tax & Investor Fit (10)	6	Hybrid likely <65% net equity → 24-mo LTCG; SBI distribution may attract retail not suited to SIF floor

★ iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short • ICICI Prudential • TFS 74 — BUY (Satellite)

Role: Aggressive SMID alpha sleeve for HNI portfolios. ≥65% in mid+small caps, ≤35% in large caps for liquidity, ≤25% short via derivatives. India's largest equity SIF (₹1,090 Cr). NAV ₹9.02 currently — entry-price advantage.

PILLAR	SCORE	REASONING
P1 Manager Pedigree (20)	18	Naren brand + Divya Jain SMID specialist; institutional-grade FM stack on SMID long-short
P2 Strategy Coherence (15)	13	SMID long-short is structurally where alpha is most defensible — wider valuation dispersion, more shorts available
P3 AMC Platform (15)	14	ICICI Pru research advantage; gathered ₹1,090 Cr in 2 months despite SMID drawdown
P4 Cost & Liquidity (10)	7	TER ~0.79%; 1% exit <12 mo; daily redemption ✓
P5 Risk Architecture (15)	10	SMID + 25% short cap = high-vol profile by design; -10% drawdown in 2 months illustrates limit
P6 Track Record (15)	6	NAV ₹9.02 (-9.8% since launch) — tough start in catastrophic SMID crash
P7 Tax & Investor Fit (10)	6	Equity LTCG 12.5% after 12 mo — best tax bucket; satellite sleeve only (5–10% of equity allocation)

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR AN HNI BUILDING A SIF ALLOCATION

Two BUYS + two ACCUMULATEs is your starting palette.

For most ₹50L–₹2Cr investors, the right opening position is a 60/40 split: 60% in a Hybrid Long-Short (pick one of Altiva, Magnum, or iSIF Hybrid based on age and risk tolerance), 40% in iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 as the aggressive sleeve. Both BUYS are at ICICI Prudential — which raises the per-AMC concentration question. For investors uncomfortable with single-AMC concentration, substitute Altiva for the hybrid core and use iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 for the satellite. This splits across two AMCs, requires ₹20 lakh aggregate (₹10L floor at each), and accesses the two highest-conviction picks on our shelf.

★ Important — TFS is not investment advice

These scores reflect the Trustner Research Desk view as of the publication date. They are **not** personal investment recommendations. The right SIF for any individual depends on factors not captured by a single score — corpus size, time horizon, existing portfolio, tax circumstances, family commitments, liquidity needs. A TFS of 78 does not mean every investor should buy iSIF Hybrid; it means iSIF Hybrid is the highest-conviction fund on Trustner's shelf at this point in time. Always discuss your specific situation with a qualified advisor before committing capital.

[Take the Suitability Quiz to see which TFS picks match your profile →](#)

10 The Seven Categories Explained

What each SEBI-permitted category is actually trying to do.

★ Hybrid Long-Short (77% of category AUM)

Defined equity-debt bands. The dominant SIF flavour. Examples: Altiva, Magnum, iSIF Hybrid, Apex, Titanium Hybrid, Arudha Hybrid, qSIF Hybrid. Best fit: BAF replacement or FD-plus positioning for ₹50L+ HNI.

Equity Long-Short

≥80% equity allocation, ≤25% unhedged short. All-cap flexicap with derivative overlay. Examples: qSIF Equity LS, Diviniti, DynaSIF, Arudha Equity. Best fit: aggressive HNI seeking alpha-with-tax-efficiency.

Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short

≥65% in stocks ranked >100 by market cap — i.e. SMID-focused long-short. Best fit: aggressive HNI bucket; SMID alpha hunt with hedging discipline. Examples: iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100, qSIF Equity Ex-Top 100, WSIF Equity Ex-Top 100, Altiva Equity Ex-Top 100 (in NFO).

Sector Rotation Long-Short

≥80% concentrated across up to 4 sectors. Tactical thematic. Examples: *Quant has filed; no live fund yet*. Expected H2 2026.

Active Asset Allocator Long-Short

Dynamic across equity, debt and commodity with derivatives. Multi-asset tactical. Examples: DynaSIF AAA, qSIF AAA, iSIF AAA (in NFO). The category most likely to win mass-affluent flows in 2026.

Debt Long-Short / Sectoral Debt LS

≥80% debt with derivative shorts. *No live funds yet.* Two categories awaiting first AMC. Expected late 2026 / early 2027.

11 The HNI Allocation Playbook

Illustrative frameworks by corpus tier. Not advice. Personal portfolios depend on personal facts.

The following frameworks are *illustrative*. They assume reasonable equity tolerance, ≥5 year horizon, top-bracket tax exposure, and no immediate liquidity need. Adjust to your circumstances; verify with your advisor.

Tier A — ₹50 lakh portfolio (emerging affluent)

BUCKET	ALLOCATION	RATIONALE
Direct equity / equity MF	₹20 L (40%)	Core long-term growth
Hybrid MF / BAF	₹10 L (20%)	Conservative equity exposure
One SIF (Hybrid LS)	₹10 L (20%)	Single-SIF discipline — pick by age/risk
Debt / FD	₹8 L (16%)	Emergency liquidity
Gold / other	₹2 L (4%)	Diversifier

Tier B — ₹1 crore portfolio (HNI sweet spot)

BUCKET	ALLOCATION	RATIONALE
Equity MF (multi-cap, mid, small)	₹35 L	Core equity engine
iSIF Hybrid LS (ICICI Pru)	₹12 L	BAF replacement, Naren brand
Altiva Hybrid LS (Edelweiss)	₹10 L	Income-with-equity-tax bucket
Debt MF + bonds	₹25 L	Yield
Insurance / gold	₹18 L	Protection + diversification

Tier C — ₹5 crore portfolio (Premium HNI)

12 Risks & The Contrarian View

What could break the SIF story.

This report has been bullish on the structural case. Honesty demands the other side.

1. The category is unproven through a full cycle.

Fourteen months is one bad-market test. The hybrid funds passed it. The equity funds failed it. Neither result is final. A genuine bear market — defined as twelve-month-plus drawdown of 25%+ — would test the 25% short cap differently. Drawdown discipline depends on derivative liquidity, which depends on derivative market conditions, which can deteriorate exactly when needed most. Investors who treat 14-month NAV charts as evidence of permanent structural advantage are misreading the data.

2. The TER reality is not yet settled.

SIF TER caps are at ~2.25% gross, with direct plans currently averaging 0.4–1.0%. Regular plans (which trail through MFDs like Trustner) are higher by the trail commission. As AUM scales, TER should compress. But as AMCs compete for active management talent, TER could go the other way. The cost-advantage case against PMS / AIF depends on this compression holding.

3. Fund manager flight risk is real.

Several SIFs ride on a single named manager. Sankaran Naren is 60+ — succession risk over a 10-year hold is non-zero. Dhawal Dalal anchors Altiva's debt sleeve; his departure would materially affect the fund. Gaurav Mehta runs Magnum solo. Key-person risk should be priced into every allocation decision.

4. SEBI could change the framework.

The 25% short cap, the ₹10 lakh minimum, the seven-category restriction — all are SEBI choices, all are amendable. A future SEBI may tighten (lowering the short cap further) or loosen (opening additional categories, lowering the floor) the framework. Either direction could create winners and losers among existing funds.

5. The tax case depends on continued Section 10(23D) treatment.

The post-tax wealth-preservation case rests entirely on the fund-level Section 10(23D) exemption. Any future Finance Act could tighten this — the precedent of the 2023 debt-MF indexation withdrawal demonstrates that mutual-fund tax treatment is not immutable. Investors should monitor budget cycles closely.

6. The Quant overhang is unresolved.

Quant MF is among the four AMCs with the most live SIF strategies. Their SEBI front-running investigation from 2024–25 remains open. A material adverse finding could force AMC restructuring and disrupt investor positions across qSIF Equity LS, qSIF Hybrid, qSIF Ex-Top 100 and qSIF AAA. Trustner's view is that qSIF strategies remain on monitor pending regulatory clarity.

13 The 12-Month Outlook

Predictions, each with a conviction level. Hold us accountable.

HIGH CONVICTION

Category AUM crosses ₹30,000 Cr by May 2027

HDFC, Nippon, UTI, Axis, DSP launches alone account for 30%+ AUM contribution at modest gather rates. Existing AMC's continue to scale. ₹30K Cr is roughly conservative.

HIGH CONVICTION

All 7 SEBI categories have at least one live fund by Q1 2027

Debt LS and Sectoral Debt LS are the two categories without live funds. Quant has filed for Sector Rotation. Pipeline AMC's will fill the gaps to be competitive.

MEDIUM CONVICTION

SIF flows accelerate as PMS AUM stagnates

PMS net inflows have moderated since 2024. For the ₹50L–₹2Cr cohort, SIF is the structurally cleaner choice. Distributor incentives favour SIF gather over PMS gather.

MEDIUM CONVICTION

At least one SIF crosses ₹5,000 Cr AUM individually

SBI Magnum's distribution muscle or Sankaran Naren's brand at ICICI Pru could push a single SIF past ₹5,000 Cr — making it the largest single hybrid LS scheme in India.

MEDIUM CONVICTION

Equity Long-Short SIFs catch up performance-wise

A recovering market post-March 2026 drawdown should help equity LS funds turn positive. Whether they justify their volatility premium remains an open question.

LOW CONVICTION / CONTRARIAN

SEBI tightens the 25% short cap further

If equity LS funds experience a second drawdown without delivering, regulator may intervene. Less likely than market consensus — SEBI usually loosens before tightening — but worth monitoring.

LOW CONVICTION / CONTRARIAN

Accredited Investor floor genuinely activates at scale

The ₹1 lakh floor for accredited investors requires functional Accreditation Agency infrastructure that does not yet exist at scale. Could happen — but probably 2027–28, not 2026.

LOW CONVICTION / CONTRARIAN

A SIF SIP product is introduced

SEBI could permit post-floor SIPs (after initial ₹10L deployment) at sub-₹1L monthly. This would meaningfully expand the addressable market. We see preparation; no firm regulatory signal yet.

14 Why the wrapper matters more than the strategy.

An editorial on the 2026 wealth-management decision that will compound for a decade.

There is a habit of mind, common among Indian HNI investors, of obsessing over the alpha and ignoring the wrapper. Show them two funds — one with a 15% historical CAGR and a 30% slab-rate tax, the other with a 13% CAGR and a 12.5% LTCG — and most will pick the higher-CAGR option. This is, in nearly every case, the wrong choice. The arithmetic is unforgiving: the second fund delivers higher post-tax wealth in less than three years and the gap compounds from there.

The Specialized Investment Fund category is, structurally, the right wrapper for a specific Indian investor: the household with ₹50 lakh to ₹2 crore of liquid AUM, a top-bracket tax exposure, a five-year horizon, and a need for institutional-quality strategies that are not available in standard mutual funds. For that household, the SIF is not just a new product — it is the new default. It compounds at MF-grade tax. It hedges via 25%-unhedged-short capability mutual funds cannot access. It discloses bi-monthly in a standardised ISID format. It is regulated, listed (for closed-ended variants), and audited within the same governance perimeter that protects ₹50 lakh crore of Indian mutual fund AUM.

The argument that defeats SIF, in our view, is not "alpha will be insufficient." It is "I want concentrated equity exposure in my own demat" (then PMS is right) or "I want unleveraged exposure to commodities and FX" (then specific ETFs or futures positions). Outside those edge cases — and they are edges — the wrapper case for SIF is strong enough that the burden of proof rests on the advisor who recommends an alternative.

We have a habit, in financial commentary, of describing every regulatory development as either revolutionary or trivial. The SIF is neither. It is a careful, well-engineered piece of plumbing that closes a gap in the Indian wealth-management spectrum. It will not make anyone rich who is not already disciplined. It will, for the disciplined investor in the right bracket, preserve roughly seventy lakh of wealth per crore of allocation over the coming decade. Over enough decades and enough households, that compounds into a measurable improvement in the financial health of the Indian upper middle class.

That is what good regulation looks like.

— *The MeraSIF Editorial Desk, May 2026*

Read the report. Then run your own numbers.

The framework above is general. Your situation is specific. Book a 20-minute consultation with a Trustner SIF advisor.

[Book a consultation](#)

[Run the Tax Calculator](#)

[Take the Suitability Quiz](#)



Methodology & Sources

How this report was assembled.

Universe construction. The SIF universe (24 funds) was assembled by cross-referencing AMC scheme information documents, the AMFI SIF NAV directory, SIF360 and SIFPrime aggregator listings, and SEBI scheme filings as of 28 May 2026. Funds in active NFO (4 schemes) are tagged distinctly from live funds (20 schemes).

AUM figures. Category-level AUM (₹10,620 Cr, Mar 2026) is sourced from AMFI category disclosures. Fund-level AUM is reported as disclosed by the AMC in its most recent factsheet. Where AMC disclosure was unavailable as of writing, the entry is flagged "Data gap."

NAV figures. NAVs are sourced from Groww and Tickertape aggregations of AMC daily NAV publications as of 25 May 2026. NAVs change daily; verify before transacting.

Performance and post-tax modelling. Illustrative post-tax wealth calculations in Section 5 assume constant 12% gross CAGR, single-asset hold (no churn), top-bracket investor (~39% effective with surcharge), and TER assumptions footnoted in the chart. Real outcomes vary materially with churn, sequencing, and individual tax circumstances.

Regulatory references. All regulatory characterisations reference SEBI/HO/IMD/IMD-PoD-1/P/CIR/2025/26 (27 Feb 2025), SEBI/HO/IMD/...CIR/2025/49 (9 Apr 2025), and SEBI/HO/IMD/IMD-RAC/P/CIR/2025/54 (11 Apr 2025), and the amendment to the SEBI (Mutual Funds) Regulations 1996 inserting Chapter VI-C (effective 16 December 2024).

Independent data sources

[AMFI India](#) — SIF directory and NAVs

[SEBI](#) — master circulars and amendment text

[SIFPrime.com](#) — independent comparison platform

[SIF360.com](#) — NFO and live SIF tracker

[Edelweiss Altiva SIF](#) — official AMC microsite

[Groww](#) — Magnum Hybrid NAV history

[Tickertape](#) — Magnum SIF returns aggregation

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Mutual Fund and SIF investments are subject to market risks. Read all scheme-related documents carefully before investing.